ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 16: **The Necklace (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** comparing her life with a dream of wealth	She felt entitled to luxury.
2	**(b)** claiming status one does not have	Pretension.
3	**(d)** very high interest that causes ruin	Ruinous.
4	**(c)** generosity and affection	He sacrifices his hunting plan.
5	**(a)** ball and garret	Glamour versus misery.
6	**(a)** poverty	She is brought low.
7	**(a)** ten years of hardship	Dishonesty prolonged trouble.
8	**(c)** Honesty is the best policy	Telling the truth at once would have saved them.
9	**(d)** Why did Madame Forestier lend the necklace so easily?	Needs reasoning.
10	**(a)** she accepted work and met her friend without shame	She becomes honest and strong.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It establishes her desire for luxury (1) which drives her later choices and the loss of the necklace (1).	1+1
12	Mathilde's hands become rough and her looks fade (1) so much that her old friend does not recognise her (1).	1+1
13	It shows people judged by dress and jewels (1) and exposes the emptiness of such show (1).	1+1
14	The ball is a moment of glitter and admiration (1) set against ten years of drudgery, sharpening the irony (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He shows great sacrifice for a necklace. The reader learns only at the end that it was paste. The gap between effort and result creates deep irony.	1+1+1
16	It is shiny and valued but fake. It stands for false show. Its loss brings real suffering.	1+1+1
17	(a) What did Mathilde borrow? (b) How long did the loan take to repay?	1+1+1
	OR: Mathilde values appearance and wishes to look wealthy. The necklace she wears is not real. The story shows that shows and show-off may be false.	1+1+1
18	The third-person narrator reports events with irony. We see Mathilde's faults and her endurance. The reader is led to judge but also pity her.	1+1+1
	OR: If Mathilde had told the truth, she would have saved ten years. This is the third conditional.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Define vanity (1). Mathilde's longing for luxury (1). Borrowing the necklace (1). Consequences of loss (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Headline (1). Who and where (1). The story of the debt (1). Quotes (1). Concluding line (1).	2+2+1
20	Dramatic expectation (1). The sacrifice (1). The reveal (1). Effect on reader (1). Link to theme (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Meaning of the title (1). Symbol of vanity (1). Central object (1). Another title: 'The Price of Pride' (1). Reason (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Mathilde rich; she is a **middle-class** woman who dreams of luxury, married to a petty clerk in the Ministry of Education.
- Writing that the necklace was real; Madame Forestier's necklace was **paste**, worth at most 500 francs, so the sacrifice was needless.
- Mixing up the cost: the Loisels paid **36,000 francs** for the replacement and spent **ten years** repaying the debts.
- Not stating the moral: *pride and vanity* and not telling the truth lead to ruin; honesty at the start would have saved them.
- Saying Mathilde's husband was lazy; **M. Loisel** was loyal and gave her the 400 francs he had saved for a gun.

- Spelling slips: *Mathilde Loisel, Madame Forestier, necklace, francs, ball*; and missing the ironic end.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 16: **The Necklace (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** she wanted to look rich	Appearance.
2	**(a)** the loss of the necklace	Loss changes life.
3	**(b)** it highlights class differences	Class and status.
4	**(b)** show she did not check the necklace	She casually accepted it.
5	**(d)** economical, with a sharp ironic ending	Maupassant's style.
6	**(a)** critical but sympathetic	Irony and pity.
7	**(c)** The Loisels bought a replacement for 36,000 francs.	A stated detail.
8	**(a)** relative clause	Relative.
9	**(c)** irony	Irony.
10	**(d)** Mathilde deserved her fate.	Judgement.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It reveals the worthlessness of what they suffered for (1) and leaves the reader reflecting on vanity (1).	1+1
12	Endurance and resolve (1) and acceptance of manual work without complaint (1).	1+1
13	He loved her and shared the responsibility (1) and understood that blame would not repay the debt (1).	1+1
14	She is generous and trusting (1) and does not even examine the returned case, showing carelessness about wealth (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Mathilde's lack of honesty with her friend caused her ruin. Honest talk would have saved ten years. Honesty is the basis of trust.	1+1+1
16	The closing shock gives the story force. It forces the reader to review the whole story. The impact is immediate and lasting.	1+1+1
17	Social ambition makes people overreach. Mathilde wanted to join a higher class for one night. It cost her years of her life.	1+1+1
	OR: At first she disliked ordinary tasks and dreamed of luxury. After the debt she did all the housework herself. She accepted work with dignity.	1+1+1
18	Pride stopped Mathilde from confessing. She preferred to suffer than admit the loss. The result was ten years of hardship.	1+1+1
	OR: She lends the necklace and gives the final revelation. She is an innocent cause of events. Her unawareness adds to the irony.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Mathilde: vain, poor, driven (1). Forestier: rich, generous, careless (1). Their friendship (1). Their meeting after ten years (1). The contrast (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Address and date (1). Salutation (1). Regret about the secret (1). Reaction to the news (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Introduction (1). Mathilde's discontent (1). Consequences (1). Examples around us (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Mathilde's focus on looks (1). The necklace is false (1). Real life is hard (1). Value of character over show (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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- Spelling slips: *Mathilde Loisel, Madame Forestier, necklace, francs, ball*; and missing the ironic end.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 16: **The Necklace (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** dissatisfied	Dissatisfied.
2	**(c)** it was only a misfortune	Not a blessing.
3	**(c)** The necklace was found to be worthless.	Passive.
4	**(d)** False pride can ruin a life.	Moral.
5	**(a)** past perfect	had + V3.
6	**(b)** arduous	Arduous = hard.
7	**(b)** the struggle to repay debt and live	Idiom.
8	**(a)** If Mathilde had told the truth, she would have saved ten years.	Third conditional.
9	**(a)** admirable but may be wasted by earlier dishonesty	Balanced reading.
10	**(a)** The Price of Vanity	Theme.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A word to Madame Forestier would have ended the problem (1) and silence caused ten years of loss (1).	1+1
12	They valued honour and wished to repay (1) but their pride prevented them from admitting the loss (1).	1+1
13	The loss of the necklace is an accident (1) but the consequences follow from the Loisels' choices (1).	1+1
14	The necklace is the object that changes their life (1) and symbolises vanity and illusion (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Before, she lived in modest comfort but felt poor. After, she lived in real poverty. The contrast shows how discontent can lead to greater loss.	1+1+1
16	(a) The necklace was bought by the Loisels. (b) It was lost by Mathilde.	1+1+1
17	Shock at the revelation, pity for Mathilde, and a sense of the waste of her sacrifice. A reflective mood follows.	1+1+1
	OR: He is simple, devoted and practical. He gives up his own plans and works for years. He never reproaches his wife.	1+1+1
18	Although Mathilde was poor, she wanted to look rich.	1+1+1
	OR: She learns the cost of vanity and the value of hard work. She gains strength and humility. She sees life realistically.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction (1). Giving up the gun money (1). The loss (1). Years of work (1). Final reflection (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Pride gives way to endurance (1). She accepts labour (1). She loses beauty but gains strength (1). Her speech becomes rough (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	The ball as status event (1). Pressure to dress well (1). Borrowing to meet expectations (1). Results (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: State your view (1). Vanity and silence (1). Excessive punishment (1). Role of chance (1). Balanced conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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MASTERMIND